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December 22, 1966
INTERIM REVISION OF
Fed. Spec. ZZ-M-43a
July 15, 1952

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

MATS, FLOOR (FOR CHAIRS)

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, D. C., 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification ZZ-M-43a, dated July 15, 1952.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION.

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for a hard pressed composition type floor mat.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Classes, sizes and types. The floor mats shall be of one type and the following classes and sizes, as specified (see 6.2).

Class 1. Smooth finish on both sides.

Class 2. Smooth finish on top surface, rough finish on floor side.

Size 1. 36 inches by 48 inches.

Size 2. 48 inches by 54 inches.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS.

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

U. S. Department of Commerce Commercial Standard:

CS 251 - Hardboard

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Pringing Office, Washington, D. C., 20402.)

3. REQUIREMENTS.

3.1 Material. The material for the floor mats shall be tempered hardboard (hard pressed vegetable fiber or other compounded materials) smooth one side or both sides, unfinished surface, board plain.

3.2 Construction. The mat shall be cut from one piece of the material specified in 3.1, and shall be designed with a single lip. The lip shall be positioned at the center of one of the short sides, (see Figure 1).

3.3 Size

3.3.1 Dimensions and tolerances. The full width and full length of the floor mat shall be as follows: Size 1 - 36 inches wide by 48 inches long; Size 2 - 48 inches wide by 54 inches long. A tolerance of ± 1 inch will be permitted in the width and length.

3.3.2 Width and length of single lip. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the lip for size 1 and 2 mats shall be of the following minimum dimensions: Size 1 - 17 inches wide by 9-1/2 inches long; Size 2 - 19 inches wide by 10 inches long.

3.3.3 Thickness. Unless otherwise specified, the mat shall be 1/4 inch nominal thickness with a minimum of 0.225 and a maximum of 0.265 as thickness limits.

3.4 Weight. The weight for size 1 shall not be less than 12 pounds nor more than 15 pounds and the weight for size 2 shall not be less than 18 pounds nor more than 22 pounds for the 1/4 inch thick mats. Other thickness specified shall be correspondently proportional to the foregoing weights.

3.5 Modulus of rupture. The modulus of rupture shall meet the requirements of CS251 for the specified tempered hardboard when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.6 Serviceability. The mats shall lie flat on a flat surface without showing signs of warp or curl. Mats shall not break, crack, crumble, curl or show visible indentation when tested as specified in 4.3.1.

3.7 Color and finish. Unless otherwise specified, (see 6.2), the color of the mat shall be brown. There shall be no spotting or change in color of the mats when tested as specified in 4.3.3. Class 1 mats shall have a smooth, polished, water-resistant finish on the top surface and the floor side shall have a rough finish. The rough surface on the floor side shall be of a quality to minimize slipping and skidding. The class 2 mats shall have a smooth, polished, water-resistant finish on the top surface and the floor side. The edges of the mats shall be smoothly beveled and the corners rounded.

3.8 Workmanship. The mats shall be free from cracks, embedded foreign matter, blisters, and other defects which affect their appearance or which may impair their serviceability. The finished mats shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. Occurance of defects shall not exceed the applicable quality levels.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection for acceptance. Examination shall be in accordance with the provisions of MIL-STD-105, except as otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 Examination of the end item. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one mat. The inspection level shall be Level I of MIL-STD-105. The defects found during examination of the end item shall be classified in accordance with Table I. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 major defects per hundred units and 6.5 total defects per hundred units.

TABLE I. Classification of defects

Defects	Classification	
	Major	Minor
Material - not as specified	X	
Edges noticeably warped or curled	X	
Material contains cracks, blisters and foreign matter	X	
When specified, not rough on one side	X	
Color not as specified		X
Edges not smoothly beveled		X
Corners not completely rounded		X
Any discoloration over an area greater than 1 square inch	X	
Not a smooth polished finish	X	

4.2.2 Dimensional examination. The mats shall be examined for dimensional defects. A defect shall be classified as any deviation from dimensions specified herein.

4.3 Tests. The methods of testing specified in paragraphs 4.3.1, 4.3.2, and 4.3.3 wherever applicable, shall be followed. The physical and chemical values specified in section 3 apply to the average of the determination made on a sample unit for test purposes as specified in the applicable test method. The sample unit shall be one mat. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one mat. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet any test requirement specified. The sample size (number of sample units) shall be in accordance with Table II.

Table II.

Lot size	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 thru 22,000	3
22,001 and up	5

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4.3.1 Service test. A flat hard surface floor (wood or concrete) covered with carpet and a chair with swivel-type casters, having metal or hard composition wheels 1-1/2 inches in diameter and having a 5/8 inch tread, shall be used for the test. The seat of the chair shall have an applied load or force of 250 plus or minus 10 pounds during the test. The chair shall be rolled from the floor over the edge, on to each sample mat, across the mat and over the outer edge on to the floor. The procedure shall be repeated twenty (20) times in succession, in as nearly the same places on the mat as practicable. The mat shall be examined for evidence of cracking, broken edges, crumbling and damage to the finish.

4.3.2 Modulus of rupture. The method of testing shall be as specified in CS251.

4.3.3 Water-resistant finish. A small portion of the surface shall be thoroughly cleaned by wiping vigorously with a clean dry cloth. Using a medicine dropper or glass rod, one drop of water shall be placed on the clean surface. After five (5) minutes, tap or shake off the water and again wipe off the surface with a clean dry cloth. The mat shall be unwetted and unmarked by this treatment and the cloth shall not be discolored by the color of the mat.

4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packing and marking requirements comply with section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with Table III. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table III. Classification of Preparation for Delivery Defects

Examine	Defects
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, distortion of container.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY.

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Six mats 36 x 48 inches, or 4 mats 48 x 54 inches in size, shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, V3c, FTC. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendex to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level B. Six mats 36 x 48 inches, or 4 mats 48 x 54 inches in size, shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, style FTC or OPF. Bursting strength of the fiberboard shall not be less than 275 p.s.i. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. The mats shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES.

6.1 Intended use. Mats covered by this specification are intended to protect carpet from wear and to allow easy movement of office chairs. They shall be designed with a single lip for extending under desks or tables.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of the specification.

b. Class required (see 1.2.1).

c. Size required (see 1.2.1 and 3.3).

d. Color required if other than brown (see 3.7).

e. Width of lip if other than specified (see 3.3.2).

f. Selection of the applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1).

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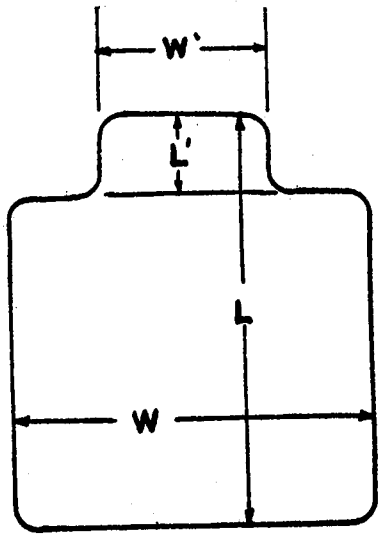


FIGURE 1.—*Single lip*

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